

Poverty may be the most foundational risk factor for poor health outcomes. Although poverty thresholds are calculated in a variety of ways, many international organizations define poverty thresholds as 50% of the median household income in a given country. Since the United States Census Bureau first began publishing an official U.S. poverty estimate in the 1960s, the percentage of the population living in poverty has fluctuated between roughly 10% and 15%. Extensive research shows a correlation between social stratification and health outcomes, with better outcomes corresponding to higher strata.

Concentration of Poverty

According to U.S. Census Bureau data, roughly 1 in 7 Americans is living in poverty, with almost 14 million residing in "high-poverty" neighborhoods (40% or more of residents below the federally defined poverty threshold), nearly double the amount since 1990. High-poverty neighborhoods also tend to have the highest rates of violent crime, so living in these neighborhoods poses both immediate (eg, physical assault) and long-term health threats, as living in an unsafe neighborhood acts as a chronic environmental stressor.

Poverty and Isolation

Poverty also prevents or limits access to many productive social activities, such as working, buying goods and services, community and political involvement, and engagement with social networks. The most impoverished members of society are often marginalized and may engage with mainstream society very little, if at all.

Transmission of Poverty

Poverty is transmitted across generations; numerous studies have found that individuals born into poverty are more likely to raise their own children in poverty. A longitudinal study of 100 households concluded that transmission of poverty occurs because lower-income parents lack economic resources, social connections, and knowledge about the education system, not because they differ from higher-income parents in wanting to help their children succeed. Experts also suggest that the education system perpetuates income disparities; schools in high-income neighborhoods have the most funding, best teachers, and highest graduation rates, whereas schools in low-income neighborhoods face numerous obstacles to obtaining supplies, retaining qualified teachers, and preventing student attrition.

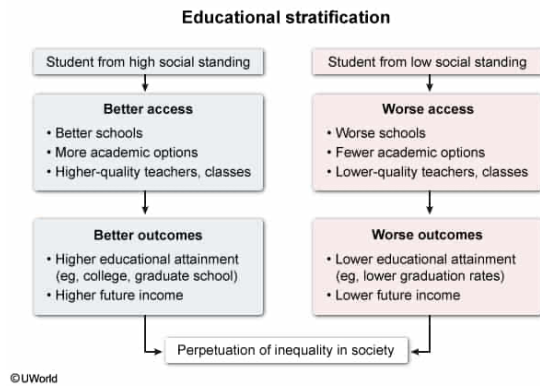
The experts' suggestion about the education system in the final paragraph draws most directly from which of the following sociological concepts?

- ☐ A. Stereotype threat [1%]
- ☐ B. Formal curriculum [1%]
- ☐ C. Teacher expectancy [1%]
- ✓ ☒ D. Educational stratification [96%]

Correct

95% answered correctly

Explanation:



Educational stratification refers to the mechanisms that produce **inequality** in **educational access** (eg, schools available to students) and **outcomes** (eg, graduation rates, college matriculation) in society. Students are stratified in the education system as a result of social characteristics, such as parent's income or influence.

Educational stratification occurs on multiple levels. For instance, students with high social standing (eg, wealth) have many options (eg, well-funded local public schools, private schools), whereas students with low social standing have fewer options (ie, limited access to quality schools and teachers).

The experts' suggestion in the final paragraph that the education system perpetuates income disparities through the unequal distribution of resources (ie, funding, quality teachers) draws most directly from the concept of educational stratification.

(Choice A) Stereotype threat occurs when members of a group are made aware of a negative stereotype about their group before engaging in an activity, causing performance to suffer. The experts' suggestion about the education system does not reflect stereotype threat.

(Choice B) **Formal curriculum** includes the explicit, official content taught to students in the educational system, whereas the hidden curriculum promotes certain values and behaviors implicitly. The stratification of the educational system is an aspect of the hidden (not formal) curriculum.

(Choice C) Teacher expectancy occurs when a teacher's beliefs about a student result in the student meeting the teacher's expectations and is thought to occur as a result of the teacher's behavior toward the student. The experts' suggestion about the education system does not reflect teacher expectancy.

Educational objective:

Educational stratification refers to the social mechanisms that produce inequality in educational access (eg, school options) and outcomes (eg, graduation rates).

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 402477

System:
Demographics and Social Structure

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To produce an aggregate measure of social stratification (Paragraph 1), a researcher would be most likely to assess which of the following factors?

- ☐ A. Power, charismatic authority, and property
- ☐ B. Social role, social capital, and social networks [30%]
- ✓ ☒ C. Social class, social status, and power [53%]
- ☐ D. Social role, social identity, and social class [15%]

Correct

52% answered correctly

Explanation:

Social stratification	
Social class	Economic assets (eg, income, property)
Social status	Prestige (ie, favorable reputation) among others in society
Power	Ability to exert control over the actions of others

Social stratification is the **hierarchical organization** of **individuals** in **society** based on social class, social status, and power:

- **Social class** is largely determined by economic resources (eg, income, property). Wealthy individuals are at the top of the social hierarchy, whereas those in the working and lower classes are at the bottom.
- **Social status** refers to one's prestige (reputation). Certain careers (eg, physician), personal characteristics (eg, attractiveness), and achievements (eg, winning an Olympic gold medal) confer status that is not necessarily tied to wealth (although it can be).
- **Power** is the ability to control others. Certain careers (eg, politician) and accomplishments (eg, a large social media following) increase one's power.

Therefore, in order to produce an aggregate measure of social stratification, a researcher would be most likely to assess *social class*, *social status*, and *power*.

(Choice A) Although one's power and property (ie, an indicator of social class) are important measures of social stratification, charismatic authority results from extraordinary claims or personal appeal (eg, leaders are seen as legitimate because they are inspiring). Power, charismatic authority, and property would not provide the best aggregate measure of social stratification.

(Choice B) Social role (expected behavior in social situations), social capital (the advantageous ties in one's social network), and social networks (nonhierarchical webs of interaction between people) would not provide the best aggregate measure of social stratification.

(Choice D) Although one's social class is an important measure of social stratification, social role (expected behavior in social situations) and social identity (how ideas about oneself are shaped by group membership) are not useful for an aggregate measure of social stratification.

Educational objective:

Social stratification is the hierarchical organization of individuals in society based on their social class (eg, income), social status (eg, prestige), and power (ie, influence over others).

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402478

System:
Demographics and Social Structure

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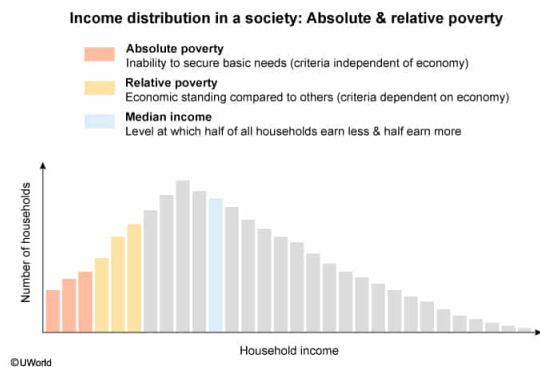
Does the passage provide a threshold for absolute poverty?

- ☐ A. No, there is no standardized definition of absolute poverty [8%]
- ☒ B. No, the threshold described in the passage is based on a comparison that is relative to others within a given country [71%]
- ☐ C. Yes, the passage describes a threshold below which individuals are unable to meet their basic needs [8%]
- ☐ D. Yes, the threshold described in the passage is based on a global standard that can be applied to any given country [11%]

Correct

70% answered correctly

Explanation:



Absolute poverty is the **inability** to secure the **basic necessities** of life, such as food, clean water, and shelter. **Relative poverty**, which is defined in **comparison** to the **economic conditions** of **others**, is a more subjective measure encompassing quality-of-life issues, such as relatively longer travel times to reach medical care using public transportation because one cannot afford a car.

The first paragraph describes poverty thresholds defined as 50% of the median household income in a given country, which is a measure of *relative* (not absolute) poverty.

(Choice A) Absolute poverty has a relatively standardized definition: the inability to meet the basic necessities of life, regardless of where one lives. Relative poverty is based on the economic standards of others, so it is less standardized and more dependent on the economic circumstances of others.

(Choice C) The first paragraph describes the poverty threshold as 50% of the median household income in a given country (relative poverty), not as the threshold below which individuals are unable to meet their basic needs (absolute poverty).

(Choice D) Although the threshold described in the first paragraph is a global standard that can be applied to any given country, it is the standard for *relative poverty*, not absolute poverty.

Educational objective:

Absolute poverty is the inability to secure basic life necessities (eg, food, shelter). Relative poverty, defined in comparison to the economic conditions of others, is the inability to meet the standards of the society in which one lives (eg, inability to afford a car if most others in society have a car).

Time spent: 0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 402479
System:
Demographics and Social Structure